The financial demands of military operations and other contributions to OEF on the relatively restricted Pakistan defense budget (approximately $2.5 billion in 2001) quickly threatened to become unsustainable. Initially, the U.S. used a variety of methods to reimburse Pakistan and other coalition partners for their contributions to OEF and the GWoT, which eventually resulted in Congress providing the CSF authority.

Without the CSF authority or a similar mechanism to reimburse Pakistan for its level of effort in OEF, it is unlikely that Pakistan would have the financial capacity to deploy and maintain sizable military forces in the FATA and other locations along the Pakistan-Afghanistan border to support U.S. and International Security Assistance Force (ISAF) military operations in Afghanistan. Such support has been significant. Since December 2001, Pakistan has conducted 91 major and countless small operations in the FATA and other locations along the border with Afghanistan.

The cost to Pakistan of these operations, in human terms, has been significant. Approximately 1,400 Pakistani security forces members have lost their lives since 2001 in the GWoT; since July 2007, over 700 Pakistanis have been killed by suicide bombings. CSF reimbursements to Pakistan have been a significant factor in Pakistan's ability to assist U.S. operations in the GWoT.

DoD Oversight of CSF

DoD regularly reviews implementation of the CSF program to ensure it is effective and complies with Congressional intent. DoD frequently refines the review and approval process for CSF reimbursements to adapt to coalition country systems and to apply lessons learned in the contingency environment. A series of meetings with involved parties took place in conjunction with the 2006 revision. OSD Comptroller is presently promulgating revised 2008 guidance. Useful inputs from independent entities – such as the DoD Inspector General and the Government Accountability Office (GAO) – combined with our internal initiatives and visits with responsible parties throughout the process have, and will continue to, enhance oversight and facilitate improved communications and consistency. The various offices within the U.S. Embassy in Islamabad, U.S. Central Command, and the Office of the Secretary of Defense each play a role in managing the program and in identifying opportunities for enhancement.

Pakistan – like the other 26 recipient nations of CSF – is a sovereign country. Their bookkeeping standards, processes and sensitivity about military operations are different and, at times, less transparent than our own. The political circumstances under which nations like Pakistan operate make their processes somewhat different from our own. In addition, the tribal areas of Pakistan are 'denied areas' – not only to U.S. forces, but largely to Pakistani military forces as well. This impacts their responsiveness, apparent transparency, and ability to work with us on the ground to conduct on-site verification of claimed expenses. The Government of Pakistan provides documentation for all of its CSF claims. However, the GAO appears to operate on a presumption that receipts are available for all items, when the reality is that receipts are not readily available for

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